REPORTED SPEECH

We use reported speech to tell people what somebody said or though in the past, or what happened. But be careful! Tenses change only when the time and speaker are different.

TENSE CHART	DIRECT SPEECH	INDIRECT SPEECH
PRESENT SIMPLE-PAST SIMPLE	I **work** in Paris	He said he **worked** in Paris
PRESENT CONTINUOUS-PAST CONT.	I **am working**	He said he **was working**
PAST SIMPLE-PAST PERFECT	I **worked**	He said he **had worked**.
PAST CONTINUOUS-PAST PERFECT CONT	I **was working**	He said he **had been working**
PRESENT PERFECT SIMPLE-PAST PERFECT	I **have worked**	He said he **had worked**
PRESENT PERF.CONT-PAST PERFECT CONT	I **have been working**	He said he **had been working**
PAST PERFECT-NO CHANGE	I **had worked**	He said he **had worked**
PAST PERFECT CONT-NO CHANGE	I **had been working**	He said he **had been working**

OTHER VERB FORMS

WILL-WOULD
I will work -He said he would work.
CAN-COULD
I can sing -He said he could sing.
MUST-HAD TO
I must work -He said he had to work.
MAY-MIGHT
May I help you? -He asked if he might help me.
SHALL-SHOULD
What shall I do? -He asked what he should do.

PRONOUNS SOMETIMES CHANGE

BE CAREFUL!
Remember, pronouns sometimes change.
Study these examples:
-Don't tell **him** –he said.
He asked me not to tell **him**. (no change)
-'I like **you'** –Mary told me.
Mary told me that she liked **me**. (change)

TIME REFERENCES

DIRECT SPEECH	INDIRECT SPEECH
Now	Then
Today	That day
Here	There
This	That
This week	That week
Tomorrow	The following/next day
Next week	The following/next week
Yesterday	The previous day
	The day before
Ago	Previously/before
Two days ago	Two days previously/before
Tonight	That night
Last Saturday	The previous Saturday
	The Saturday before
Next Saturday	The following Saturday
	The next Saturday
	The Saturday after
	That Saturday

TELL

TELL + PERSONAL OBJECT
We tell somebody
-Tina told me to phone her.
-My sister told us not to wake her up in the morning.

SAY

SAY + TO + OBJECT
-He never said that to me.
TO REPORT
-He said he was exhausted
-Tom said he had done it.

ASK

OBJECT + INFINITIVE
TO REQUEST
-He asked me to translate it.
TO QUESTION
Ask her if she likes tea.

LIVEWORKSHEETS

EXERCISE 1 Rewrite the sentences in reported speech

1-He was studying yesterday. She said he had been studying the previous day

2-I will go to the party. He told me that he would go to the party

3-Mary can't stand mean people. He said that Mary couldn't stand mean people

4-I must call my sister tomorrow. He said he had to call his sister the next day

5-I don't like coffee. She told me she didn't like coffee

6-Please, do me a favour. She asked me to do her a favour

7-What shall I do about it? He asked what he should do about it

8-I have forgotten his number. She said she had forgotten his number

9-May I sit here? She asked if she might sit there

10-I have been waiting for ages. She said she had been waiting for ages

11-Tim works in an office. He told me Tim worked in an office

12-I have been to Paris twice. She said she had been to Paris twice

13-My husband is in Poland. She told me her husband was in Poland

14-I won't do the shopping tomorrow. He said wouldn't do the shopping the next day

15-Neil has already seen this film. She said that Neil had already seen that film

16-Gloria is sitting in her room now. He said Gloria was sitting in her room then

17-I don't go to parties. She told me she didn't go to parties

18-I have been working in the garden. She said she had been working in the garden

EXERCISE 2 Choose the correct option.

When I ***saw/seen*** Mary at the office ***this/that*** morning, she wasn't looking very well. In fact she ***had looked/looked*** a bit tired. I ***tell/asked*** her what the matter ***is/was*** with her but she wouldn't ***tell/say*** me. I ***wanted/had been wanting*** to know what was going on so I ***ask/asked*** Phil but he ***didn't/wasn't*** know, either. Two hours later, at about ten o'clock, we ***met/were meeting*** at the canteen to have a cup of coffee. But Mary ***didn't/wasn't*** order anything to drink. I knew she loved coffee so that was quite strange. When I asked her why she ***wasn't/didn't*** want anything to drink she said she ***didn't have/wasn't having*** her wallet. Her husband ***had been taking/had taken*** it. I ***said/asked*** her how she ***was coming/had come*** to work and she said that as she didn't have any money at all she ***come/came*** on foot. So that's why she ***is/was*** so tired! She lived in a nearby town which was ten kilometers away! No wonder why she ***is/was*** exhausted!

EXERCISE 3 Change the time reference.

Sometimes more than one answer is correct.

1-Sally is leaving **today**.
He said Sally was leaving that day

2-He visited London **last week**.
He said he had visited London the previous week

3-We had an argument **last night**.
He said they'd had an argument the previous night

4-I'm not eating **now**.
He said he wasn't eating then

5-Jimmy is coming **next week**.
He said Jimmy was coming the following week

6-I forgot my key **yesterday**.
He said he'd forgotten his key the previous day

7-I'll call you **tomorrow**.
He said he would call me the following day

8-I don't live **here** anymore.
He said he didn't live there anymore.

9-I'm meeting Phil **tonight**.
She said she was meeting Phil that night

LIVEWORKSHEETS

Nidia Nicolle Guerrero Hernández IDYS10C

10/10

DIRECT SPEECH - REPORTED SPEECH

A. Present simple → Past simple : ✓ V2 / -ed
✖ didn't + inf.

1. Helen said, "I like the new job." → Helen said that she ..... the new job.
   like
   likes
   liked

2. John said, "I have a new car." → John said that he ..... a new car.
   haved
   had
   has

3. Meg said, "We often buy books." → Meg said that ..... often ..... books.
   we / buy
   they / are buying
   he / bought

4. "I am on holiday here." → He said that .... on holiday .....
   he / am / here
   she / were / then
   they / was / there

5. "Mary is at home today." → He said that Mary ..... at home .....
   was / today
   are / yesterday
   is / that day

6. "I travel in summer." → He said that .... in summer.
   he / travel
   I / travelling
   we / travelled

7. "I don't like Mondays," Ina said. → Ina said that .... Mondays.
   he / didn't like
   she / didn't liked
   they / doesn't like

LIVEWORKSHEETS

DIRECT SPEECH - REPORTED SPEECH

B. Present continuous → Past continuous :

✓ am / is / are + V + ing ✓ was / were + V + ing

1. "Jill is studying a lot now." → He said that Jill ..... a lot .....

did studying	now
were studying	that day
was studying	then

2. John said, "I am eating dinner." → John said that .... dinner.

he	was eat
she	were eat
John	was eating

3. "We are sleeping there." → He said that ....

we	is sleeping	there
they	were sleeping	here
he	were sleep	then

4. "Lupe is coming next week." → He said that Lupe ....

were coming	last week
was coming	the following week
wasn´t coming	

5. He said, "We are working." → He said that ....

they	were working
their	was work
our	was working

6. "I am doing my homework." → He said that he .... homework.

doing	his
were doing	he
was doing	her

7. "Our cat is playing here." → He said that ..... cat ....

their	was play	there
they	was playing	now
our	were played	here

LIVEWORKSHEETS

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LANGUAGE ARTS DIRECT & INDIRECT SPEECH

0/10

State whether the following are examples of direct or indirect speech.
Be sure to write your answers as either direct speech or indirect speech. No capital letters.

1. "Have you finished your chores as yet?" asked mom.
   Mom asked if had finished my chores
2. They told her they would arrive a little late.
   "We would arrive a little late," they told
3. "You'll never guess what I've just seen!" said Sam, excitedly.
   Sam said excitedly that I would
4. She replied, "No, I haven't seen him since lunchtime."
   She replied that she hasn't seen
5. Sasha asked me to call her back later.
   "Call me back later", said Sasha
6. Paul came in and said, "I'm really hungry."
   Paul came in and said
7. The teacher asked me to have a seat.
   "Have a seat", asked me the teacher

Grade 5 KERR
LIVEWORKSHEETS